

Matthew Zakis

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SUMMARY

Senior Network Engineer and L3 SME with extensive experience supporting, optimizing, and modernizing enterprise LAN/WAN and data center environments across regulated industries. Skilled in improving network reliability, reducing operational cost through efficient design and troubleshooting, and strengthening security and compliance across Cisco and multivendor network OS platforms. Provides advanced escalation support, resolves complex routing, segmentation, and infrastructure issues, and drives stability through clear documentation (HLD/LLD/MOP) and cross-team collaboration. Known for optimizing network performance, eliminating recurring issues, and delivering scalable, maintainable infrastructure solutions including proficiency with Transport and Fiber optical environments to include: DWDM/CWDM. Exposure to redundant Ring environments SONET, OC3 long-haul MOE

Routing

BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, IS-IS (exposure) MPLS (LDP, RSVP, RSVP-TE training) , L2VPN, IPVPN High-availability routing, VRF segmentation, ECMP Circuit-level troubleshooting and transport/IP path analysis

Data Center & LAN L2/L3 Switching

Modern L3 spine-leaf data center designs. SME with Cisco Catalyst 2k–9k, 2900–3000 Series, 4900 Series Cisco Nexus 2k/3k/5k/7k/9k StackWise, VSS, LACP, VLAN segmentation POP/DC migrations, infrastructure exits, new build implementations

Security & VPN

IPSec VPNs, Cisco ASA 5500 Series Palo Alto PA-800 Series with Panorama TACACS+, RADIUS authentication

Voice & Collaboration SIP, VG200 gateways, Cisco Call Manager (CUCM)

Monitoring & Management

SolarWinds NPM/NCM Cisco Catalyst Center / DNAC Progress Cisco Meraki WhatsUp Gold NetBox IPAM, InfoBlox DHCP/DNS Cisco ISE (TACACS+/RADIUS authentication) Visio topology diagrams, HLD/LLD documentation, MOPs, audit reports

Platforms

Cisco ISR/ASR (2900/4300), ASR9K, 7600 Series, 3600 Series Cisco Catalyst 2k–9k, 2900–3000 Series, 4900 Series Cisco IE Industrial Ethernet Series (IE 4000 and related platforms) Cisco 4K Series (ISR 4xxx platforms) Cisco Nexus 2k fabric extenders to Nexus 5k/7k/9k data center platforms Juniper EX/QFX, M/MX Series Nokia 7705/7750 (exposure) via Nokia SR series.

Automation & SD-WAN Concepts SD-WAN concepts and operational workflows Hands-on experience with Versa VOS SD-WAN Training exposure to Cisco Viptela Cisco AI SD-WAN Cisco AI-driven network insights (Catalyst Center/DNAC) Cisco Meraki Dashboard exposure

Engineering Capabilities Circuit-level audits, reconciliation, and capacity planning Transport/IP buildouts across multi-vendor environments P1/P2 incident response and stabilization Cross-team collaboration with PMO, Security, Systems, and Operations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network Analyst III (Contract) – Dominion Energy / Enbridge

June 2024 – January 2026

Provided Level 3 support for TSA-mandated infrastructure transition and multivendor network migration. Supported VRF segmentation, BGP/EIGRP routing, (L2VPN) and high-availability designs across Cisco ISR/ASR and Nexus platforms. Maintained and optimized MPLS ring connectivity for substations and remote sites. Performed circuit audits, capacity validation, and migration readiness for large-scale WAN environments. Utilized Cisco DNAC/Catalyst Center and NetBox for IPAM, inventory, and configuration baselines. Produced HLD/LLD documentation, MOPs, and topology diagrams. Gained hands-on exposure to Azure VNET configurations, VPN connectivity, and hybrid routing integrations. Collaborated with PMO and Security Operations to meet TSA and NERC-CIP compliance requirements. Exposure to EVPN, CLOS, and modern DC fabric concepts. Utilized CyberArk PAM for privileged credential vaulting and secure access workflows. Project topology update Migrate trunked Nexus 7k to Cisco 6504 over to Cisco StackWise 9606.

Network Administrator III – Utah Transit Authority

June 2020 – May 2024

Designed and deployed Cisco Catalyst 3500–9000 L2/L3 networks. Supported fiber-based network infrastructure including redundant ring topologies in field-distributed sites and public-facing operational services using Cisco IE4010 with REP rings. Supported Cisco ASR 1000 remediation and WAN routing improvements. Managed InfoBlox DHCP/DNS, VLAN segmentation, and IPAM operations. Performed L3 troubleshooting, outage remediation, and WAN optimization. Implemented and supported Cisco ASA 5500 (Firepower Services) and Palo Alto PA-800 firewalls via Panorama. Applied Palo Alto IDS/IPS threat prevention profiles. Evaluated FortiGate NGFW for modernization initiatives. Supported Cisco 9800 WLC and 1500–9100 APs. Provided VMware vSphere support for financial systems. Maintained Cisco Prime and Cisco Meraki, Cisco ISE for NAC with TACACS/RADIUS authentication. Led change-control projects, outage remediation, and on-call escalation.

Network Engineer – KnightPoint Systems / Hexaware

January 2015 – June 2020

Supported federal agencies (VHA, OSHA) under High Public Trust clearance. Delivered L2/L3 troubleshooting, hardware upgrades, and configuration lifecycle management. Utilized SolarWinds

NPM/NCM for monitoring and compliance. Worked in compliance-driven environments aligned with government security standards. Provided end-user support, training, and documentation. Exposure to cloud-based networking concepts through federal modernization initiatives.

Network Engineer – PacifiCorp / Rocky Mountain Power (Experis)

August 2010 – January 2015

Installed and configured Catalyst 2900 PoE switches, IP phones, and analog gateways. Supported remote energy sites with fiber, Ethernet, and uplink installations. Delivered onsite troubleshooting, ITIL-aligned incident management, and customer support. Produced user documentation and contributed to project planning and execution.

EARLY CAREER TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE (Consolidated /College Graduate)

Network Consulting & Cisco Systems Support

Delivered customized LAN/WAN solutions for private businesses, R&D groups, financial organizations, and government entities including DoD, Department of Labor, and school districts. Work included network design, hardware configuration, and secure remote-access implementations. Provided 24/7 support for LAN/WAN environments, performing onsite installation, optimization, and troubleshooting. Collaborated with vendors on MPLS, VPN, and BGP projects. Installed and configured L2/L3 switches, routers, wireless access points, and bridges. Implemented encrypted connectivity solutions including VPN tunneling technologies. Provided advanced support for Cisco Systems hardware and software, including routers (1000–7000 series) and Catalyst switches. Delivered training to network administrators on configuration, troubleshooting, and operational best practices.

CERTIFICATIONS & CLEARANCE

Level 4 Public Trust

ITIL Foundation

EDUCATION

Salt Lake Community College – A.A.S. Computer Information Systems

New Horizons CCNAX Ccompletion